WOOKYOUNG KIM, Ph.D.

Senior Researcher, KIMM | Associate Professor, UST | Thermal Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Ph.D. thermal engineer with 10+ years in electronics cooling, from pulsating heat pipes (KAIST) to AI data center cooling (single- and two-phase D2C, immersion, jet impingement) as PI/project lead at Korea's national research institute (KIMM). Combines hands-on experimental expertise (two-phase heat transfer, cryogenic testing, heat exchangers, heat pumps) with production-grade software development (Python / FastAPI / React Native). Lab-to-market record: 7 technology transfers, 26 domestic + 1 U.S. patents, 21 journal papers (13 SCI + 8 KCI), 8 registered design programs.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Thermal Management	Energy Systems	System Design & Testing	Software & Analysis
Data center cooling (ILC/DLC)	Heat pump (vapor./ads.)	Heat exchanger (PCHE/S&T)	Python / FastAPI / React Native
Immersion / Jet impingement	Liquid hydrogen vaporizer	Thermal loop construction	2-phase HT measurement
Electronics thermal design	Low-GWP refrigerant R&D	High-pressure / cryogenic sys.	VLE measurement & EOS

EXPERIENCE

Associate Professor | University of Science and Technology (UST) Sep 2026 - Present

Senior Researcher | Korea Institute of Machinery and Materials (KIMM) Jun 2021 - Present Project page »

Data Center Thermal Management

- Jet-enhanced immersion cooling for next-gen high-heat-density servers [PI, 2025]
- Immersion cooling waste heat utilization and active thermal management [Lead, 2024-2028]
- Direct liquid cooling (DLC) system for data center power-consumption reduction [Lead, 2026-2029]

Cryogenic / Hydrogen Heat Exchangers

- PCHE design & testing for LH2 vaporizers: N2 tests to -185°C / 21 MPa, -220°C / 100 MPa target [Lead, 2021-2025]
- Anti-freezing PCHE design; CFD conjugate heat transfer analysis; freezing condition experimental mapping [Lead]
- Compact PCHE development for below -200°C, 100 MPa-class hydrogen supply system [Lead, 2022-2026]

Heat Pumps & Refrigerants

- 300°C-class high-temperature heat pump system for fossil fuel replacement [Participant, 2023-2028]
- Chemisorption heat pump with electrochemical compressor; experimental characterization [Participant, 2021-2025]
- Low-GWP refrigerant VLE measurement (R-32/R-125, R-1233ZD(E)) and equation-of-state development [Participant]

Engineering Software & Apps

- AI-based automated design tool for data center DLC cooling systems [PI, 2026]
- KIMMPROP: iOS/Android thermophysical-property app (CoolProp/REFPROP via WASM) [PI, 2025] App Store » Google Play »
- 8 registered engineering design programs (PCHE, heat-pump cycle, vapor chamber, etc.) [Lead]

Impact: 21 journal papers (13 SCI + 8 KCI) | 26 domestic patents + 1 U.S. patent | 8 registered software | 7 technology transfers

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Mechanical Engineering **KAIST** 2017 - 2021
Dissertation: Study on a Thermal Network-based Model for Predicting the Thermal Resistance of Pulsating Heat Pipes
Advisor: Prof. Sung Jin Kim

M.S. Mechanical Engineering **KAIST** 2015 - 2017
Thesis: Effect of artificial cavities on the thermal performance of pulsating heat pipes
Advisor: Prof. Sung Jin Kim

B.S. Mechanical Engineering **KAIST** 2011 - 2015

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

21	26	1	8	7
Journal Papers (13 SCI + 8 KCI)	Domestic Patents	U.S. Patents	Registered Software	Tech Transfers

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SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

(1) **W. Kim** et al., "Freezing Phenomenon in PCHE for Cryogenic LH2 Vaporizer," Appl. Therm. Eng. 273 (2025)

(2) **W. Kim** et al., "Freezing Condition of PCHE for LH2 Vaporizer," J. Hydrogen New Energy 35(2) (2024)

(3) **W. Kim** et al., "Falling Film Evaporation of R-1233ZD(E): Flow & Thermal Characteristics," Korean J. ACRE 36(1) (2024)

(4) **J.S. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Pool boiling of ammonia outside enhanced tubes," Appl. Therm. Eng. 247 (2024)

(5) **H.S. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Chemisorption heat pump performance under various conditions," Appl. Therm. Eng. (2024)

(6) **D.H. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "VLE of R-32/R-125: experiment and EOS verification," J. Mech. Sci. Technol. (2024)

(7) **J. Kim, W. Kim** et al., "Liquid behavior in falling-film evaporator distributor," Physics of Fluids 35 (2023)

(8) **W. Kim** and S.J. Kim, "Fundamental issues about pulsating heat pipes," J. Heat Transfer - ASME 143 (2021)

(9) **W. Kim** and S.J. Kim, "Flow behavior effect on pulsating heat pipes," Int. J. Heat Mass Transfer 149 (2020)

SELECTED PATENTS

Showing 8 of 26 domestic patents (Korean Intellectual Property Office)

- Immersion cooling device 2024
- Immersion cooling HVAC system and method 2022
- Heat exchanger with anti-freezing capability 2023
- Micro-channel reactor 2023
- Ternary refrigerant composition and heat pump system 2022
- Adsorption heat pump evaporator and system 2023
- Heat pipe integrated reactor for adsorption heat pump 2022
- Geothermal heat supply device and heating system 2023

REGISTERED SOFTWARE PROGRAMS

All 8 programs registered with Korea Copyright Commission Details »

- 100 kg/hr hydrogen PCHE design program 2025
- Adsorption cooling simulation program 2025
- PCHE thickness design program 2024
- Vapor chamber performance analysis program 2024
- High-temperature heat pump cycle design program 2024
- Fin-tube heat exchanger design program 2024
- Heat exchanger HTC uncertainty analysis program 2023
- Lab-scale heat exchanger analysis program 2023

TECHNOLOGY TRANSFERS

7 transfers to industry partners

Phase-equilibrium property evaluation for refrigerant mixtures · Heat transfer enhancement for data center liquid cooling · Low-temperature freezing performance test of a PCHE for vehicle heat exchangers · Diffusion bonding technology for cryogenic hydrogen heat exchangers · Ultra-thin vapor chamber design technology · Heat pump design for low-dew-point dehumidifiers in battery manufacturing · Compact inverter compressor-based dress care system

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Experimental: Thermal loop design & construction (1-/2-phase) · Low-GWP refrigerant systems · 2-phase flow & heat-transfer measurement · High-pressure testing (21 MPa) · Cryogenic testing (nitrogen, -185°C) · Flow visualization

Analytical & Computational: Thermal network modeling · Heat exchanger design (PCHE, S&T, PHE) · CFD (FLUENT, COMSOL) · CAD (SOLIDWORKS, INVENTOR) · Surrogate-model optimization · CoolProp/REFPROP

Software Development: Python · JavaScript/TypeScript · C/C++ · FastAPI · React / React Native · Git · Docker · Linux

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- **Council Member**, Korean Society of Mechanical Engineers (KSME) [2026.04 - Present]
- **Committee Member**, KSME Thermal Engineering Division, Future Development Committee
- **Committee Member**, SAREK Future Growth Special Committee
- **Committee Member - Thermal Management / Cooling**, SAREK Data Center Facility Technology Division Committee [2026.03 - Present]
- **Collaborating Researcher / Mentor**, 2026 Artience Daejeon (Daejeon Cultural Foundation art-science program) [2026.03 - 2026.12]